

TidyTuesday Week 30

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Friday 24th July, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the only weekly newsletter brave enough to shove economic time series into a blender and pretend the resulting smoothie means something. As always, the machine grabbed some random pairs from FRED, ran a line through them, and dared us to feel emotions about the R-squared. We complied. Standard disclaimer, delivered with the enthusiasm of a flight attendant on their eighth leg of the day: these are randomly paired series, there is no causal claim here, and spurious correlation isn't the bug, it's the entire personality of the project.

Monday kicked things off by pairing the Fed's holdings of medium-term Treasury securities with a discontinued Consumer Price Index for services in the South. The raw regression came in with a beefy R-squared of 0.77 and a p-value with enough zeros after the decimal to make you nervous, which is exactly the kind of thing that gets a lesser blog very excited. But then we detrended it, and the R-squared quietly deflated to 0.37 and, notably, the sign of the relationship flipped from positive to negative. Nothing says "we were just both drifting upward through history like two strangers on the same escalator" quite like a relationship that reverses direction the moment you take away its trend. A trend mirage, dabbed gently with a napkin.

Tuesday, however, is where I have to put down my sarcasm mug for a second. We regressed "Nonfinancial Noncorporate Business withdrawals from income of quasi-corporations" (a phrase I am legally required to read in one breath) against depreciation of nonresidential structures, and the raw R-squared was a frankly obscene 0.98. Fine, whatever, big numbers drift together, we've seen this movie. Except after detrending it STAYED at 0.87 with a p-value that is essentially a rounding error away from zero, and the coefficient barely budged from 0.42 to 0.40. That is genuinely the rare "this might actually be a real relationship" case, and honestly it's not insane that two measures of how much big physical business assets are wearing down and being paid out would move together. I'm not saying I've discovered anything. I'm saying the machine stumbled into something that survived the interrogation, and that's practically a holiday around here.

The back half of the week returned us to our regularly scheduled nonsense. Wednesday matched the resident population of Nuckolls County, Nebraska against a medical price index for congenital anomalies, posting a gorgeous raw R-squared of 0.88 that collapsed to 0.36 once detrended, i.e., "Nuckolls County shrinking and medical prices rising both happen over time, film at eleven." And Thursday achieved the impressive feat of being unconvincing in both directions: net unilateral transfers versus the number of failed banking institutions gave us a raw R-squared of 0.005 (a rounding error wearing a trench coat) that then, absurdly, became slightly significant

after detrending with an R-squared of 0.08. So one day flatlines completely, the next its detrended residuals perk up just enough to be statistically annoying without being interesting. In summary: one relationship worth an eyebrow raise, three worth a shrug, and zero worth building a policy around. See you next week, when the blender goes again.

2 Date: 2026-07-21

Series ID: TREAS1T5

This series is titled Assets: Securities Held Outright: U.S. Treasury Securities: Maturing in over 1 Year to 5 Years: Wednesday Level and has a frequency of Weekly, As of Wednesday. The units are Millions of U.S. Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2002-12-18 and the observation end date is 2026-07-15. The popularity of this series is 21.

Series ID: CUURD300SAS

This series is titled Consumer Price Index for All Urban Consumers: Services in South - Size Class D (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index 1982-1984=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1977-12-01 and the observation end date is 2017-12-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_CUURD300SAS	R-squared:	0.774			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.765			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	82.38			
Date:	Tue, 21 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	3.15e-09			
Time:	13:11:10	Log-Likelihood:	-104.86			
No. Observations:	26	AIC:	213.7			
Df Residuals:	24	BIC:	216.2			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t 	[0.025	0.975]
const	214.5017	4.768	44.985	0.000	204.660	224.343
value_fred_TREAS1T5	6.405e-05	7.06e-06	9.076	0.000	4.95e-05	7.86e-05
Omnibus:	1.003	Durbin-Watson:	0.294			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.606	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.795			
Skew:	-0.004	Prob(JB):	0.672			
Kurtosis:	2.143	Cond. No.	1.16e+06			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

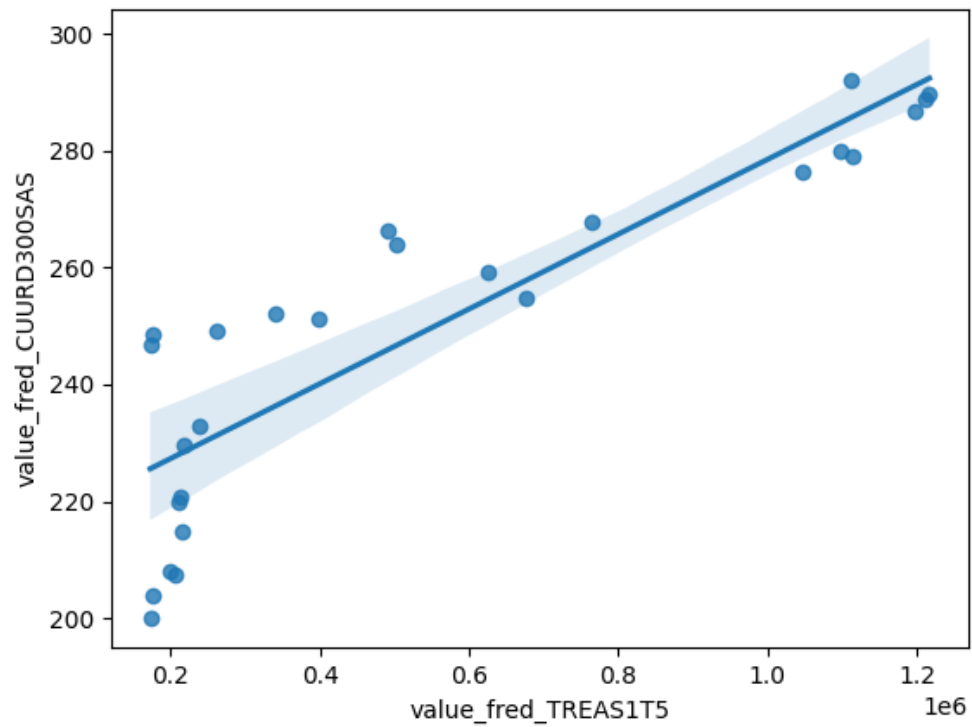


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-07-21

[2] The condition number is large, $1.16e+06$. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_CUURD300SAS_detrended	R-squared:	0.365
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.339
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	13.82
Date:	Tue, 21 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.00107
Time:	13:11:11	Log-Likelihood:	-63.094
No. Observations:	26	AIC:	130.2
Df Residuals:	24	BIC:	132.7
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	4.318e-12	0.559	7.72e-12	1.000	-1.154	1.154
value_fred_TREAS1T5_detrended	-1.309e-05	3.52e-06	-3.718	0.001	-2.04e-05	-5.83e-06

Omnibus:	0.194	Durbin-Watson:	1.006
Prob(Omnibus):	0.907	Jarque-Bera (JB):	0.403
Skew:	0.028	Prob(JB):	0.818
Kurtosis:	2.393	Cond. No.	1.59e+05

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 1.59e+05. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

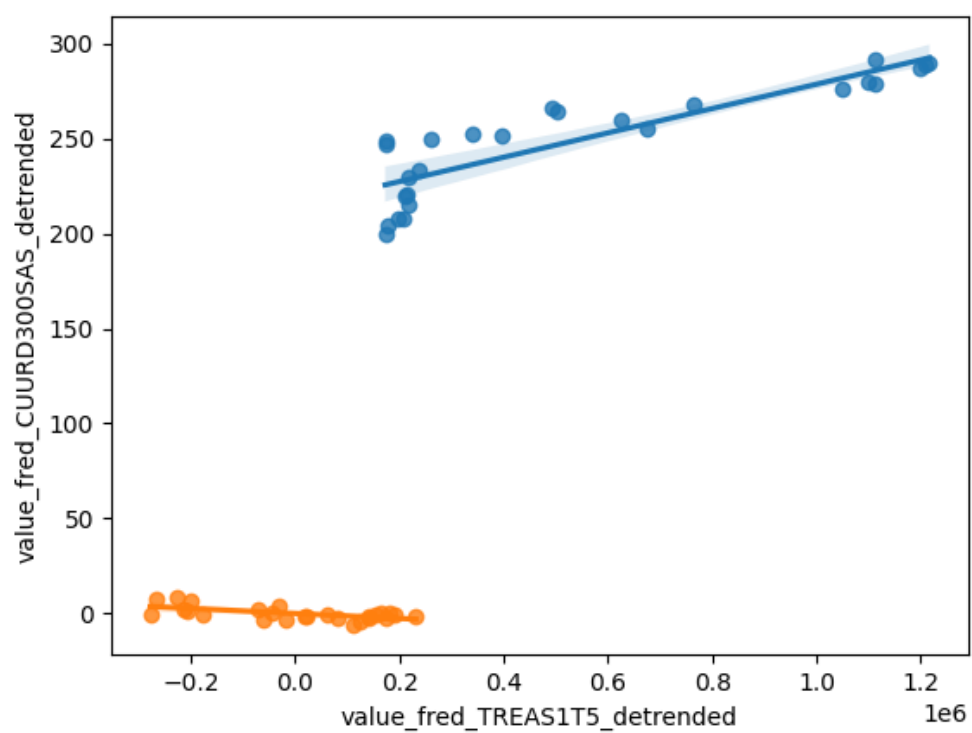


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-07-21

3 Date: 2026-07-22

Series ID: NNBICPA027N

This series is titled Nonfinancial Noncorporate Business; Withdrawals from Income of Quasi-Corporations, Paid, Transactions and has a frequency of Annual, End of Period. The units are Millions of U.S. Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted Annual Rate. The observation start date is 1959-01-01 and the observation end date is 2024-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: M1YTOTL1ST000

This series is titled Current-Cost Depreciation of Private and government fixed assets: Nonresidential: Structures and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1925-01-01 and the observation end date is 2024-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_M1YTOTL1ST000	R-squared:	0.985
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.984
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	4111.
Date:	Wed, 22 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	8.67e-60
Time:	13:16:17	Log-Likelihood:	-777.64
No. Observations:	66	AIC:	1559.
Df Residuals:	64	BIC:	1564.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1720.1069	5808.925	-0.296	0.768	-1.33e+04	9884.554
value_fred_NNBICPA027N	0.4156	0.006	64.115	0.000	0.403	0.429

Omnibus:	7.252	Durbin-Watson:	0.477
Prob(Omnibus):	0.027	Jarque-Bera (JB):	10.958
Skew:	0.289	Prob(JB):	0.00417
Kurtosis:	4.911	Cond. No.	1.31e+06

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

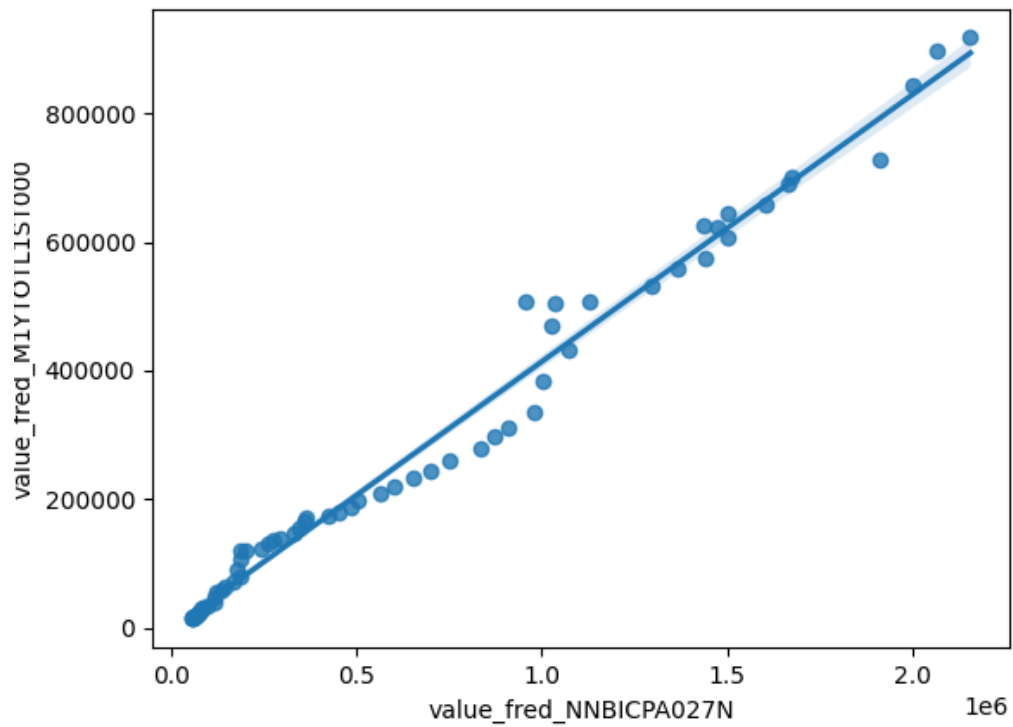


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-07-22

[2] The condition number is large, $1.31e+06$. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_M1YTOTL1ST000_detrended	R-squared:	0.873
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.871
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	439.3
Date:	Wed, 22 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	2.31e-30
Time:	13:16:17	Log-Likelihood:	-777.37
No. Observations:	66	AIC:	1559.
Df Residuals:	64	BIC:	1563.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	2.698e-09	3943.730	6.84e-13	1.000	-7878.507	7878.507
value_fred_NNBICPA027N_detrended	0.4024	0.019	20.960	0.000	0.364	0.441

Omnibus:	5.762	Durbin-Watson:	0.463
Prob(Omnibus):	0.056	Jarque-Bera (JB):	8.362
Skew:	0.128	Prob(JB):	0.0153
Kurtosis:	4.725	Cond. No.	2.05e+05

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 2.05e+05. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

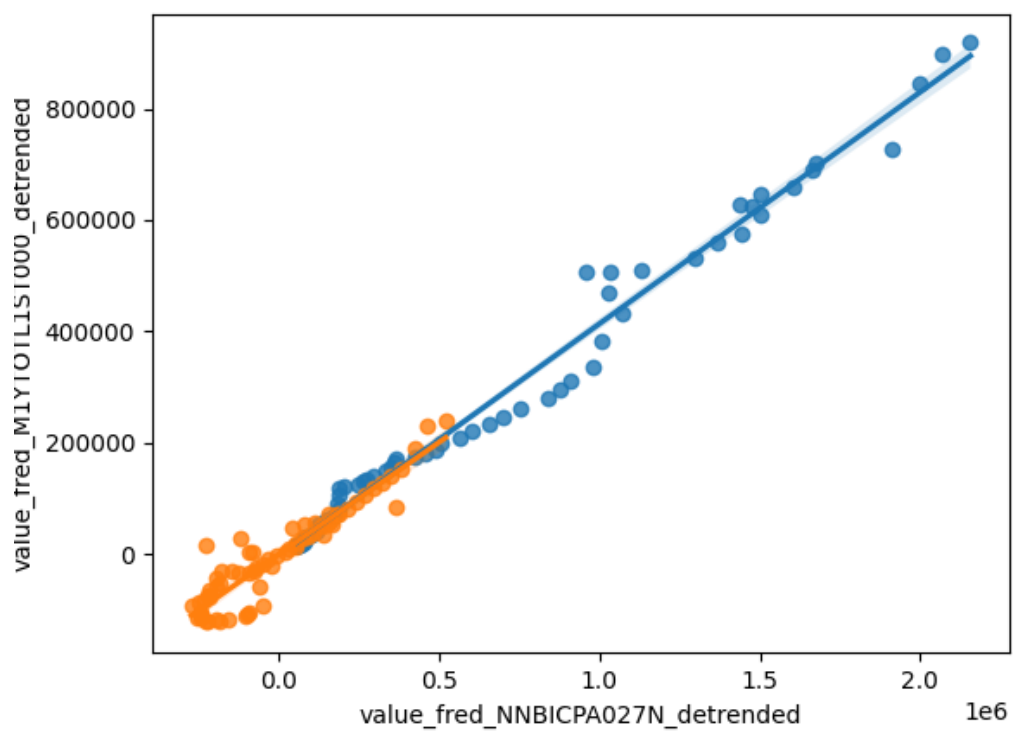


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-07-22

4 Date: 2026-07-23

Series ID: NENUCK9POP

This series is titled Resident Population in Nuckolls County, NE and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Thousands of Persons and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1970-01-01 and the observation end date is 2025-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: COGANOPIBLEND

This series is titled Medical Services Expenditures by Disease: Other: Congenital Anomalies Price Index, Blended Account Basis and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Index 2017=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2000-01-01 and the observation end date is 2021-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

4.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_COGANOPIBLEND	R-squared:	0.876			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.870			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	141.6			
Date:	Thu, 23 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	1.58e-10			
Time:	13:20:04	Log-Likelihood:	-75.559			
No. Observations:	22	AIC:	155.1			
Df Residuals:	20	BIC:	157.3			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	422.9442	28.506	14.837	0.000	363.483	482.406
value_fred_NENUCK9POP	-75.7107	6.363	-11.898	0.000	-88.985	-62.437
	Omnibus:	4.239	Durbin-Watson:	1.347		
	Prob(Omnibus):	0.120	Jarque-Bera (JB):	2.271		
	Skew:	0.630	Prob(JB):	0.321		
	Kurtosis:	3.944	Cond. No.	79.9		

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

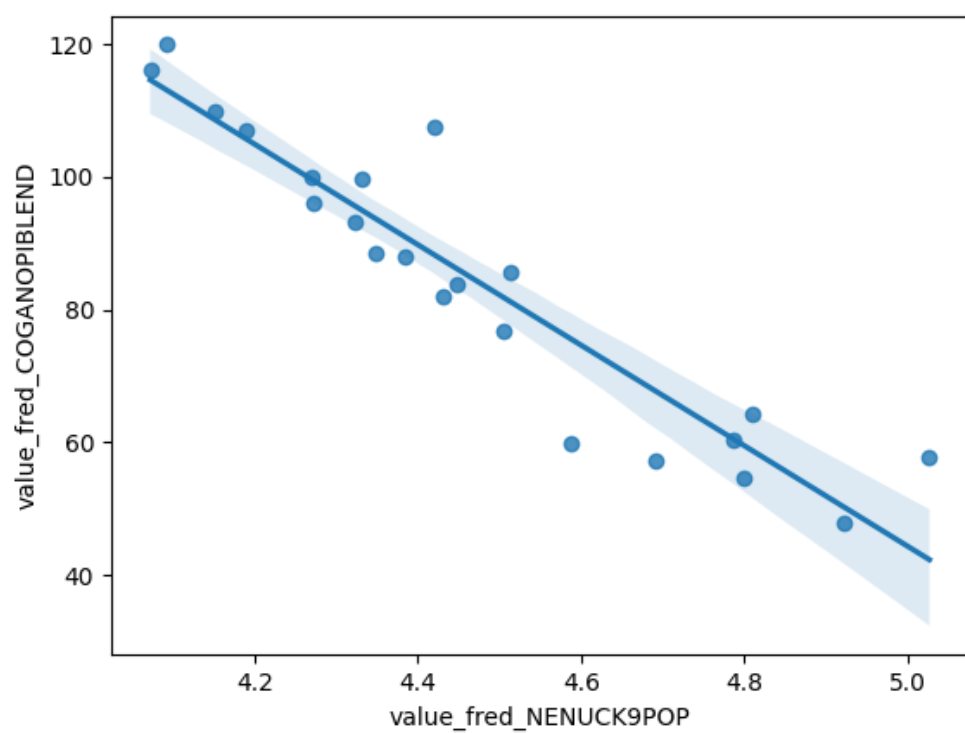


Figure 5: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-07-23

4.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_COGANOPIBLEND_detrended	R-squared:	0.358
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.326
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	11.17
Date:	Thu, 23 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.00324
Time:	13:20:05	Log-Likelihood:	-75.552
No. Observations:	22	AIC:	155.1
Df Residuals:	20	BIC:	157.3
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	6.695e-12	1.678	3.99e-12	1.000	-3.499	3.499
value_fred_NENUCK9POP_detrended	-78.2472	23.407	-3.343	0.003	-127.074	-29.421

Omnibus:	3.865	Durbin-Watson:	1.355
Prob(Omnibus):	0.145	Jarque-Bera (JB):	1.985
Skew:	0.584	Prob(JB):	0.371
Kurtosis:	3.896	Cond. No.	14.0

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

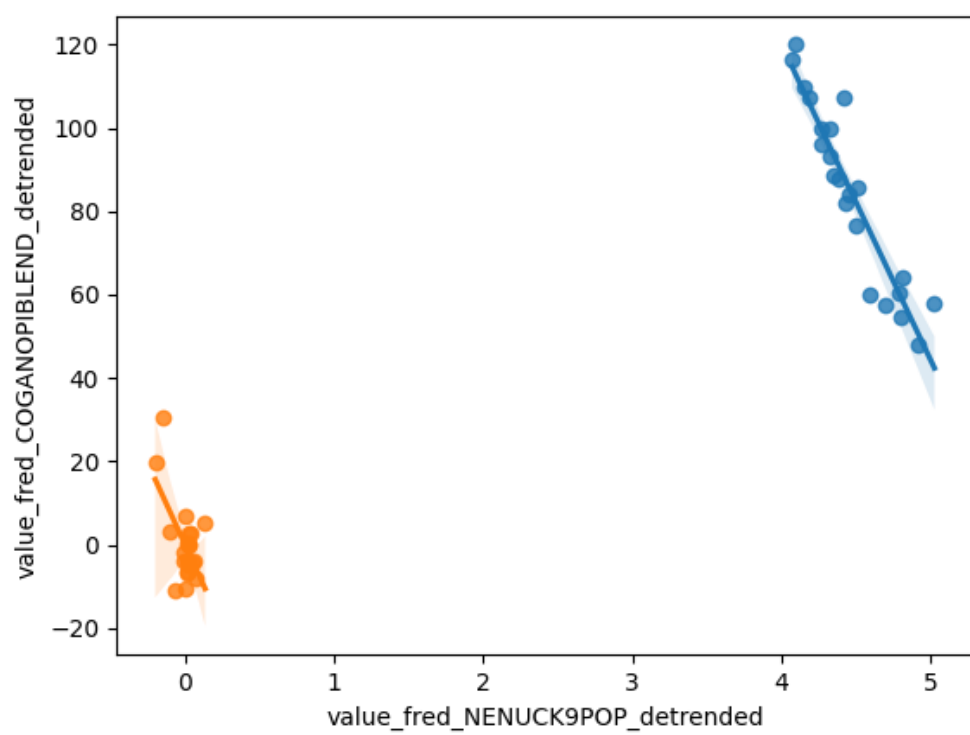


Figure 6: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-07-23

5 Date: 2026-07-24

Series ID: BOPGA

This series is titled Unilateral Transfers, Net (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Billions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1960-01-01 and the observation end date is 2013-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: BKTTPAA641N

This series is titled Failures and Assistance Transactions of all Institutions by Transaction Type (Purchase and Assumption (PA)) for the United States and Other Areas and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Number of Institutions and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1934-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

5.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_BKTTPAA641N	R-squared:	0.005
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.014
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.2713
Date:	Fri, 24 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.605
Time:	13:12:01	Log-Likelihood:	-308.19
No. Observations:	54	AIC:	620.4
Df Residuals:	52	BIC:	624.4
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	33.0760	13.835	2.391	0.020	5.313	60.839
value_fred_BOPGA	-0.1284	0.247	-0.521	0.605	-0.623	0.366

Omnibus:	41.852	Durbin-Watson:	0.265
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	110.404
Skew:	2.369	Prob(JB):	1.06e-24
Kurtosis:	8.160	Cond. No.	76.9

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

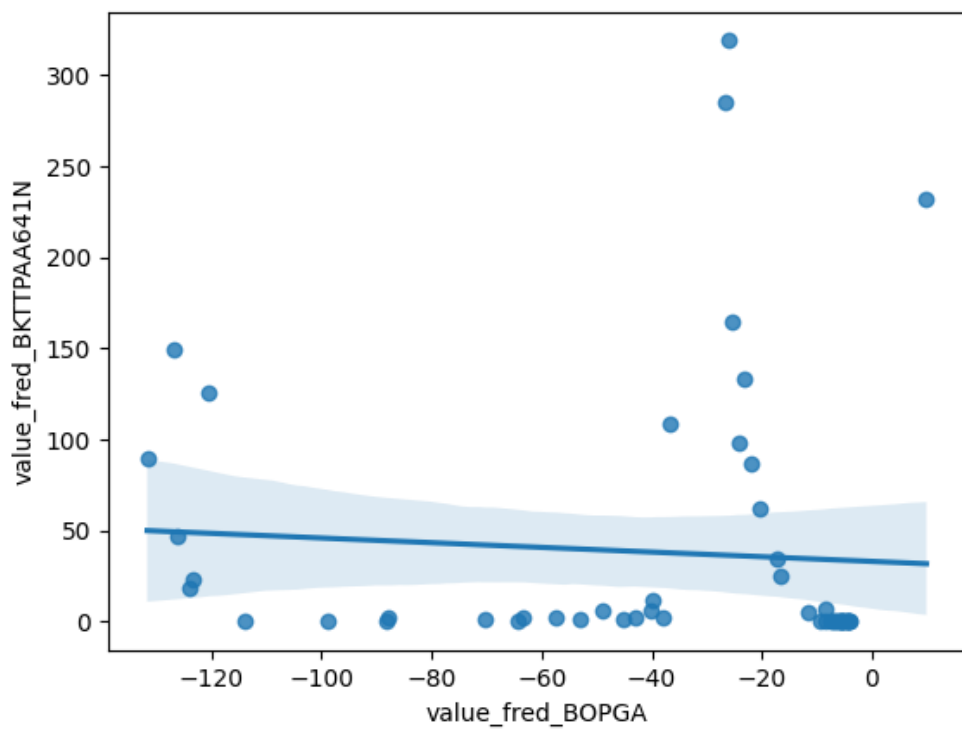


Figure 7: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-07-24

5.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_BKTPAA641N_detrended	R-squared:	0.085
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.068
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	4.844
Date:	Fri, 24 Jul 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0322
Time:	13:12:01	Log-Likelihood:	-304.45
No. Observations:	54	AIC:	612.9
Df Residuals:	52	BIC:	616.9
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-2.402e-12	9.425	-2.55e-13	1.000	-18.912	18.912
value_fred_BOPGA_detrended	1.0857	0.493	2.201	0.032	0.096	2.076

Omnibus:	31.844	Durbin-Watson:	0.291
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	64.227
Skew:	1.865	Prob(JB):	1.13e-14
Kurtosis:	6.825	Cond. No.	19.1

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

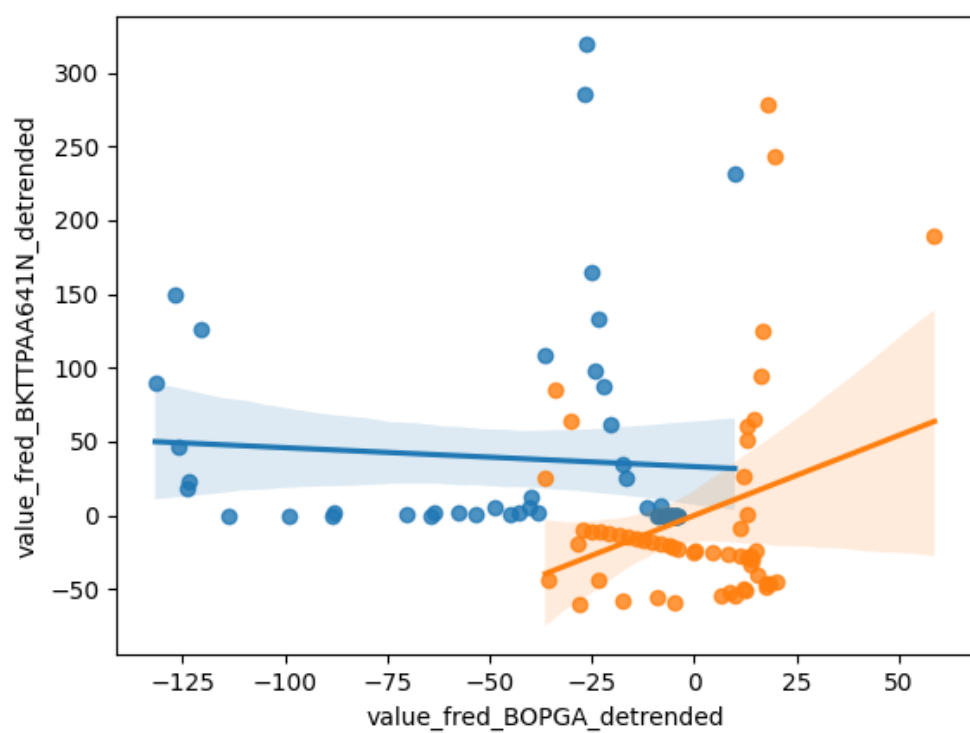


Figure 8: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-07-24